ServiceNow Workflow Design and Optimization

Client Requirements and Readiness Guide

This guide identifies the information, access, resources, and decisions the client must provide to support a successful ServiceNow Workflow Design and Optimization engagement. Completing these requirements before discovery begins helps reduce delays, improve design quality, and keep delivery aligned with agreed objectives.

1. Engagement Information

Client organization	_____
Engagement sponsor	_____
Primary client contact	_____
ServiceNow product or application	_____
Target workflow or process	_____
Target start date	_____
Desired completion date	_____

2. Engagement Objectives

The client must provide a concise statement of the business problem, the desired future state, and the outcomes that will define success. Examples include reducing fulfillment time, eliminating unnecessary approvals, improving assignment accuracy, increasing automation, improving user experience, or standardizing a process across teams.

- Business problem or opportunity: _____
- Desired outcome: _____
- In-scope workflow or process: _____
- Out-of-scope items: _____
- Success measures or KPIs: _____

3. Required Client Inputs

Please provide available materials before the first discovery session. Draft or incomplete materials are acceptable if they reflect the current process.

- Current process maps, workflow diagrams, standard operating procedures, or work instructions
- Examples of requests, cases, incidents, tasks, forms, notifications, approvals, and reports
- Existing business requirements, user stories, backlog items, pain-point logs, or audit findings
- Current service targets, SLAs, OLAs, escalation rules, and operating schedules
- Roles, groups, assignment rules, approval authorities, and segregation-of-duties requirements
- Data definitions, required fields, reference data, templates, and retention requirements
- Known technical constraints, regulatory obligations, security standards, and internal policies
- Relevant ServiceNow configuration documentation and prior design decisions

4. Stakeholders and Participation

The client is responsible for identifying participants with sufficient authority and process knowledge. Required participants typically include:

- Executive sponsor or accountable business owner
- Process owner and operational subject-matter experts
- ServiceNow platform owner, administrator, or architect
- Security, risk, compliance, data, and integration representatives, as applicable
- Representatives of affected fulfillment teams and end-user groups
- A designated decision-maker who can resolve scope and design questions promptly

5. ServiceNow Access and Environment Readiness

- Provide access to the appropriate non-production ServiceNow instance.
- Provide least-privilege roles sufficient to review the relevant applications, tables, forms, flows, business rules, notifications, SLAs, reports, groups, and configuration.
- Confirm instance version, active plugins, application scope, update-set or source-control practices, and promotion path.

- Identify access request procedures, VPN requirements, identity-provider restrictions, maintenance windows, and security review steps.
- Provide representative test data or an approved method for creating it; sensitive production data should not be shared unless expressly authorized.
- Identify the client administrator responsible for resolving access or environment issues.

6. Current-State Process Details

For each workflow, the client should be prepared to explain the trigger, requester, intake channel, required data, validation rules, task sequence, assignment logic, approvals, exceptions, escalations, notifications, closure conditions, reporting needs, and known pain points. Include process variations by business unit, geography, service, priority, or user type.

7. Future-State Design Decisions

- Which steps should be standardized, simplified, automated, added, or removed?
- What information must be captured, and at what point?
- How should work be routed, prioritized, reassigned, and escalated?
- Which approvals are required, and under what conditions may they be bypassed?
- What notifications are required, for whom, and through which channels?
- What exceptions require manual handling?
- Which service targets, controls, reports, and audit evidence are required?
- What experience should requesters, approvers, fulfillers, and administrators have?

8. Integrations and Data Dependencies

Identify every system, data source, or external team that the workflow depends on. For each dependency, provide the system owner, business purpose, interface method, data exchanged, authentication approach, frequency, error-handling expectations, environment availability, and relevant technical documentation. Examples include identity platforms, email, ERP, HR, CRM, monitoring, asset, discovery, and document-management systems.

9. Workshops, Reviews, and Decisions

- Ensure required stakeholders attend scheduled discovery and design sessions.
- Provide requested materials and consolidated feedback by agreed dates.

- Review process maps, requirements, recommendations, and designs within the stated review period.
- Record decisions, owners, and due dates for unresolved items.
- Escalate conflicts or delayed decisions through the engagement sponsor.

10. Client Responsibilities and Assumptions

- The client will provide accurate and timely information, access, resources, and approvals.
- The client will identify a primary contact who coordinates schedules, materials, and responses.
- Recommendations will be based on the information and system access available during the engagement.
- Material scope changes, unavailable environments, delayed decisions, or missing dependencies may affect schedule and effort.
- Unless explicitly included in the statement of work, implementation, data migration, custom development, testing execution, training, and production deployment are outside this design and optimization engagement.
- Final scope, deliverables, and commercial terms remain governed by the applicable agreement or statement of work.

11. Deliverable Review and Acceptance

Deliverables may include current-state findings, a future-state workflow design, optimization recommendations, requirements, user stories, process diagrams, configuration guidance, and an implementation roadmap, as defined in the statement of work. The client must designate reviewers and confirm acceptance criteria before delivery. Unless otherwise agreed, feedback should be consolidated into one response and submitted within the review period stated in the engagement plan.

12. Pre-Engagement Readiness Checklist

Ready	Requirement	Owner / Notes
☐	Objectives, scope, and success measures are documented.	
☐	Process documentation and representative examples are available.	

☐	Business owner, process SMEs, technical contacts, and decision-maker are identified.	
☐	Required ServiceNow instance access and roles are approved.	
☐	Technical constraints, security requirements, and policies are documented.	
☐	Integrations and data dependencies are identified.	
☐	Workshops and review sessions can be scheduled with required participants.	
☐	Feedback, decision, and escalation processes are agreed.	
☐	Acceptance criteria and designated reviewers are confirmed.	

13. Client Acknowledgment

By signing below, the client confirms that the information provided is accurate to the best of its knowledge, that the required stakeholders and access will be made available, and that material gaps or constraints have been disclosed.

Client representative	_____
Title	_____
Signature	_____
Date	_____